Three British Players Reach Wrexham Open Quarter-Finals

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It was a great day for British tennis fans at the Lexus Wrexham Open in Wales, as three British players won their matches to reach the **quarter-finals**.

Alicia Dudeney led the way with a long, tough match. She beat Susan Bandecchi of Switzerland, the seventh **seed**, 6-3, 6-7, 6-4. The match lasted two hours and 51 minutes. A **seed** is a player ranked among the top hopefuls in a tournament. The win was Dudeney's seventh in a row. Next she will face Elsa Jacquemot of France.

Hannah Klugman, who is only 17, also played very well. She defeated Anna Siskova of the Czech Republic, who is ranked higher than her, 6-2, 6-4. Last year, Klugman reached the final of the French Open **junior** girls' tournament. She is now ranked 341st in the world and will play Rebecca Sramkova of Slovakia, the sixth **seed**.

Jodie Burrage made it three British players in the last eight by beating fourth **seed** Noma Noha Akugue 6-1, 7-6. The second set ended in a close **tiebreak**, 11-9. Burrage will next play Spain's Marina Bassols Ribera, the fifth **seed**.

There was also a big surprise. The top **seed**, Anna Blinkova, ranked 72nd in the world, lost 6-3, 6-2 to Suzan Lamens of the Netherlands.

The tournament runs from October 18 to 25 at the Wrexham Tennis and Padel Centre. Last year's champion, Mimi Xu from Swansea, chose to play in a tournament in Canada instead, so the strong play of the three British women has cheered home fans.

The **quarter-finals** are on Friday, the **semi-finals** on Saturday, and the final on Sunday.

Word Treasure

quarter-finals -- The round of a tournament with eight players left, before the semi-finals.

seed -- A player ranked as one of the favorites and placed in the draw so top players don't meet early.

tiebreak -- A special short game played to decide a set when the score is tied.

junior -- A competition for young players, usually under 18.

semi-finals -- The round with four players left; winners go on to the final.

Background you need

In tennis tournaments, players are knocked out when they lose, so each win moves them to the next round until only two remain for the final.

The best-ranked players are called seeds, and they are spread out in the draw so they are less likely to face each other early.

A tennis match is played in sets, and when a set is tied, a tiebreak decides who wins it.

Smaller professional events like this one give rising players a chance to earn ranking points and gain experience.

Break it down

LEAD: Three British players reach the Wrexham Open quarter-finals
KEY MATCHES:
+- Alicia Dudeney beats seventh seed Susan Bandecchi in 2 hours 51 minutes, her seventh straight win
+- Hannah Klugman, 17, beats higher-ranked Anna Siskova
+- Jodie Burrage beats fourth seed Noma Noha Akugue, winning an 11-9 tiebreak
NEXT OPPONENTS: Elsa Jacquemot, Rebecca Sramkova and Marina Bassols Ribera
UPSET: Top seed Anna Blinkova loses to Suzan Lamens
CONTEXT: Defending champion Mimi Xu chose to play in Canada instead
SCHEDULE: Quarter-finals Friday, semi-finals Saturday, final Sunday

Why it matters

Smaller tournaments like Wrexham give young and rising players, such as 17-year-old Hannah Klugman, a stage to build experience and confidence.

Test what you remember

1. How many British players reached the quarter-finals?

- (A) Three
- (B) Five
- (C) One
- (D) Two

2. How long did Alicia Dudeney's match last?

- (A) 45 minutes
- (B) Four hours and 10 minutes
- (C) One hour exactly
- (D) Two hours and 51 minutes

3. How old is Hannah Klugman?

- (A) 17
- (B) 25
- (C) 21
- (D) 15

4. What was the score of the tiebreak in Jodie Burrage's second set?

- (A) 7-4
- (B) 6-2
- (C) 11-9
- (D) 10-8

5. Who beat top seed Anna Blinkova?

- (A) Suzan Lamens
- (B) Rebecca Sramkova
- (C) Mimi Xu
- (D) Alicia Dudeney

6. Why did last year's champion Mimi Xu not defend her title?

- (A) She was injured
- (B) She chose to play a tournament in Canada
- (C) She lost in the first round
- (D) She retired

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: D 3: A 4: C 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):